

GS DRAM Sentiment Indicator: Aug. 2026: Bull/bear debate continues amid positive datapoints; higher 2027 HBM pricing expectations

Our DRAM sentiment indicator for August 2026 is pointing in a *moderately positive* direction (same as June). Notable highlights include: 1) DDR5 pricing continued its upward trend in August, 2) Taiwan Tech companies overall posted solid yoy growth with Nanya Tech saw especially seeing strong growth (+720% yoy in July), and 3) Despite the ongoing bull-bear debate over decelerating price growth vs. AI-driven structural tailwinds, our expectation for 2027E HBM continues to be constructive considering tight HBM S/D and widening gap between conventional DRAM and HBM pricing.

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Exhibit 1: GS DRAM Sentiment Indicator

Indicators	Period	Sequential change	yoy change	Direction	Previous
DRAM spot pricing trend (daily)	8/28/2026	0%	799%	↑↑↑	↑↑↑
Server ODM monthly revenue trend (monthly)	July	-4%	80%	↑↑↑	↑↑↑
Aspeed monthly revenue trend (monthly)	July	16%	98%	↑↑↑	↑↑↑
Korea monthly DRAM export revenue (monthly)	July	-3%	394%	↑↑↑	↑↑↑
China smartphone shipment (monthly)	June	-36%	-17%	↓↓	↑
Nanya monthly revenue trend (monthly)	July	49%	720%	↑↑↑	↑↑↑
Supreme monthly revenue trend (monthly)	July	25%	333%	↑↑↑	↑↑↑
Second derivative of industry DRAM ASP (quarterly)	3Q26E	-20%		↓↓↓	↓↓↓
2026/2027 HBM consensus	2026/2027			↑↑	↑↑
GS view based on channel checks and feedback				↑	↑↑
Overall				↑↑	↑↑

Source: Company data, DRAmEXchange, TRASS, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Details of data points

DRAM spot pricing: DDR4 pricing continued its upward trend in August (+7% mom in August) and is trading at a +43% premium over August contract pricing. DDR5 pricing also grew at similar magnitude (+6% mom in August) and is trading at a +16% premium over August contract pricing.

Server ODM and Aspeed revenue: July server ODM (Inventec, Quanta, Wiyynn, Wistron) monthly revenue rose +80% yoy on the back of rack-level AI servers shipment ramp up and strong growth in ASIC AI servers shipment, and Aspeed's monthly revenue also showed solid yoy growth (+98% yoy) extending 50+% yoy growth streak to 6 months.

Korea DRAM export: July DRAM exports decreased by 3% mom, however increased 394% yoy, achieving the highest yoy growth rate since 2008. MOTIE attributes this result to solid demand for memory products amidst AI mass adoption and transition to agentic AI.

China smartphones: June China smartphone shipment growth recorded -17% yoy, ending 2 consecutive months of positive yoy growth. 2026 YTD shipment fell below 2025 numbers (-3% yoy in 1H26), and our Greater China Tech team expects 3Q26 shipment to decline by 10% yoy mainly due to rising memory prices dragging down end-demand.

Nanya Tech revenue: Taiwanese DRAM supplier Nanya Tech's July revenue increased by +720% yoy, showing 12 consecutive months of triple-digit% yoy growth driven by strong DDR4 pricing growth.

Supreme Electronics revenue: Taiwanese distributor Supreme Electronics' July revenue increased +333% yoy and +25% mom.

Second derivative of Industry DRAM ASP: As our latest 3Q26E DRAM ASP estimate for SEC and Hynix is for an around +17% qoq increase, we estimate the second derivative of ASP growth during the quarter to be around -20%p.

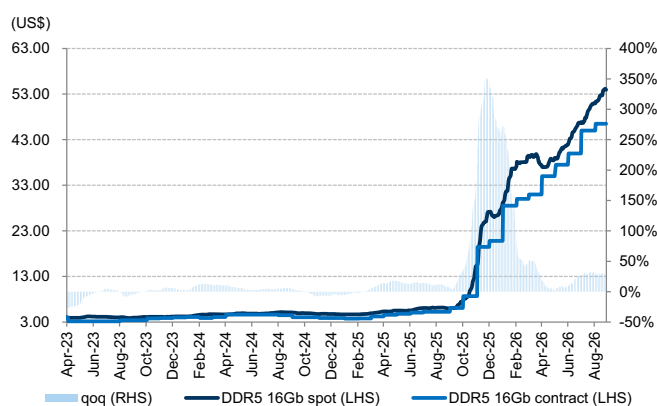
2026/2027 HBM consensus (vs. GSe): During the past 1 month, sell-side consensus (Visible Alpha Consensus Data) for Hynix's next year HBM pricing growth has notably risen to 53% yoy (vs. +32% yoy 1 month ago). We also raised our estimates to 100% yoy (from +50% yoy), hence we continue to hold a more positive view on next year's HBM pricing.

GS view based on channel checks and feedback: Based on discussion with investors, there continues to be a debate between the bears and the bulls, where the former are mainly cautious on the space due to the deceleration of memory pricing growth expected going forward, while the latter are constructive on continued robust AI-related demand and LTAs that are being signed at more favorable terms for suppliers which should help protect against downside unlike during past cycles. In terms of the near-term conventional memory contract pricing, after an expectation adjustment period during the past couple months, we believe consensus is expecting 15-20% qoq growth in 3Q26 which is inline with GSe. Considering the tight HBM S/D and the widening gap between conventional DRAM and HBM pricing, we think expectations for 2027 HBM pricing continues to be constructive.

Components of GS DRAM sentiment indicator

Through the analysis of data points, including **1)** daily DRAM spot pricing, **2)** monthly server ODM revenue, **3)** monthly revenue of Aspeed (largest BMC supplier for servers globally), **4)** monthly Korea DRAM export revenue, **5)** monthly China smartphone shipments, **6)** monthly revenue of Nanya Tech, **7)** monthly revenue of Supreme Electronics, **8)** our forecast of the second derivative of industry DRAM ASP for the forward quarter, **9)** 2026/2027 HBM consensus (vs. GSe), and **10)** our view on the sentiment in the DRAM market based on our channel checks and conversations with investors, **our DRAM sentiment indicator for August 2026 is pointing in a moderately positive direction (same as June).**

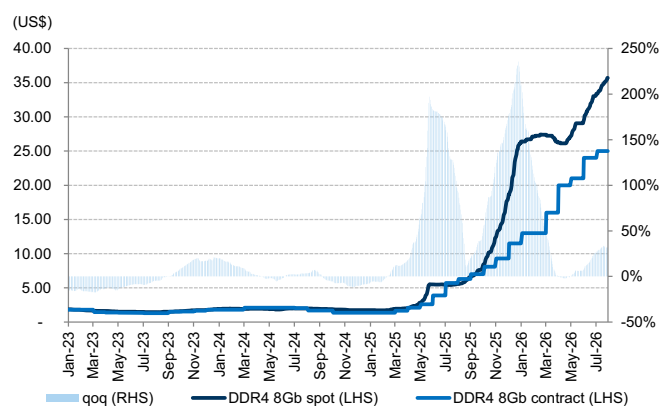
Exhibit 2: DDR5 pricing grew +6% mom in August and is trading at a +16% premium over August contract pricing.
DDR5 16Gb spot pricing trend



* DRAM spot pricing as of August 31.

Source: DRAMeXchange

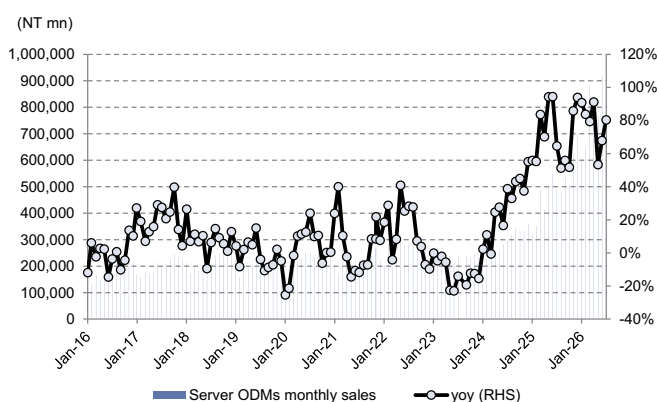
Exhibit 3: DDR4 pricing continued its upward trend in August (+7% mom in August) and is trading at a +43% premium over August contract pricing.
DDR4 8Gb spot pricing trend



* DRAM spot pricing as of August 31.

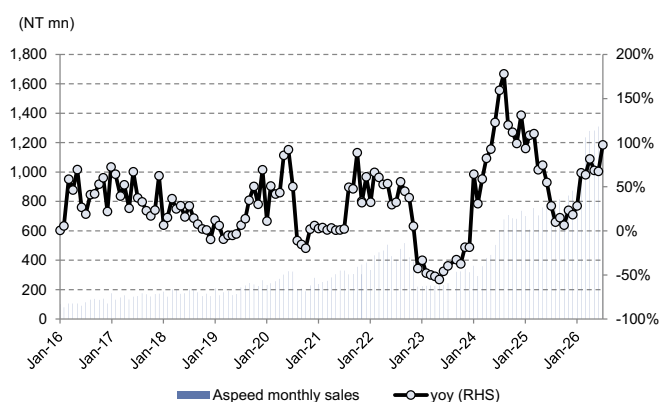
Source: DRAMeXchange

Exhibit 4: Taiwan server ODM monthly revenue rose by +80% yoy (-4% mom) in July
Taiwan server ODM monthly revenue trend



Source: Company data

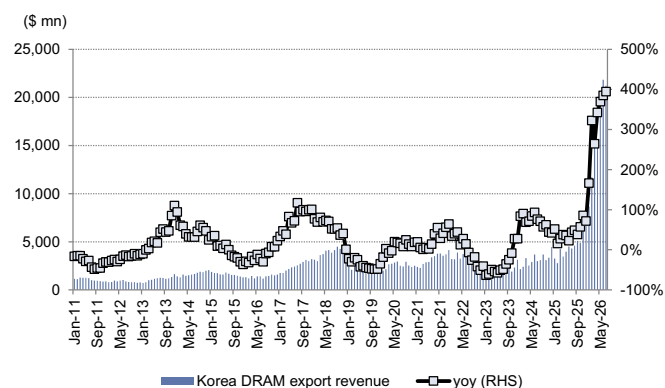
Exhibit 5: Aspeed's monthly revenue increased by +98% yoy (+16% mom) in July
Aspeed monthly revenue trend



Source: Company data

Exhibit 6: Korea DRAM exports up by +394% yoy (-3% mom) in July

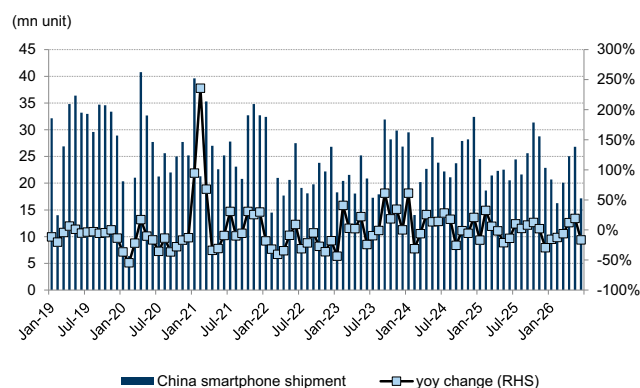
Korea monthly DRAM export revenue trend



Source: TRASS

Exhibit 7: China smartphone shipment decreased by 17% yoy (-36% mom) in June

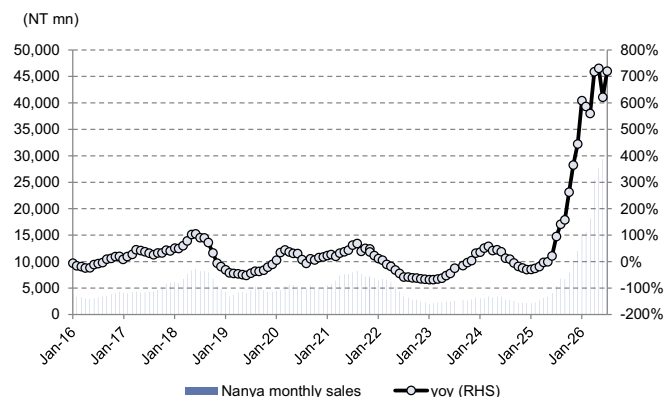
China smartphone shipment trend



Source: CAICT

Exhibit 8: Nanya's monthly revenue increased by +720% yoy (+49% mom) in July

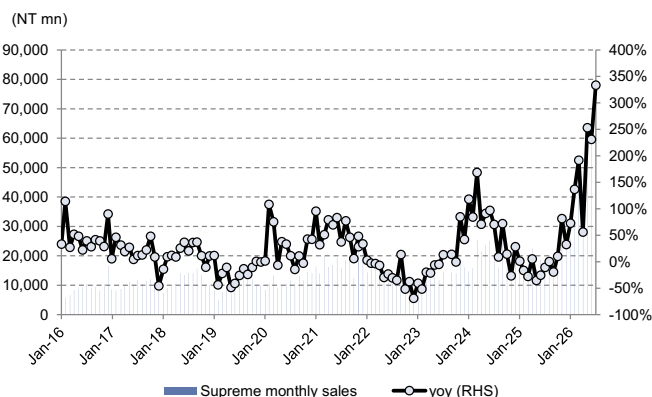
Nanya monthly revenue trend



Source: Company data

Exhibit 9: Supreme's monthly revenue increased +333% yoy (+25% mom) in July

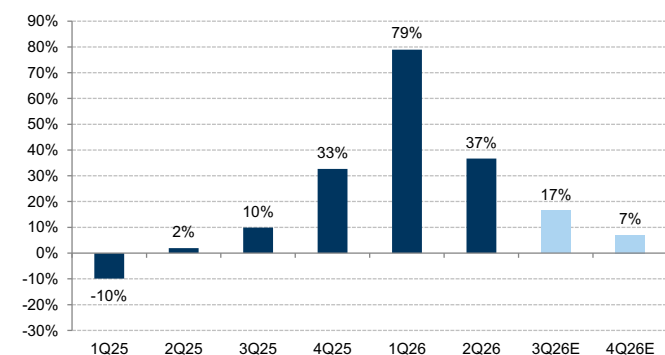
Supreme monthly revenue trend



Source: Company data

Exhibit 10: As our latest 3Q26E industry DRAM ASP estimate is for an around +17% qoq increase, we estimate the second derivative of ASP growth during the quarter to be around -20%p

SEC DRAM pricing growth assumptions



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 11: 2026/2027 Hynix HBM sell-side consensus (vs. GSe)

2026	As of 2 August			As of 31 August		
(US\$ bn)	GSE	Consensus	% diff. vs. consensus	GSE	Consensus	% diff. vs. consensus
HBM shipment growth%	36%	31%	4%p	43%	35%	8%p
HBM pricing growth%	-12%	8%	-20%p	-13%	7%	-20%p
HBM revenue	25	29	-14%	26	29	-11%
HBM OP	17	19	-10%	18	19	-6%
2027	As of 2 August			As of 31 August		
(US\$ bn)	GSE	Consensus	% diff. vs. consensus	GSE	Consensus	% diff. vs. consensus
HBM shipment growth%	29%	35%	-6%p	22%	31%	-9%p
HBM pricing growth%	50%	32%	17%p	100%	53%	47%p
HBM revenue	47	52	-8%	63	58	8%
HBM OP	37	32	16%	50	42	21%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Visible Alpha Consensus Data

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Samsung Electronics

Valuation methodology: Our 12m 2026-2027E EV/EBITDA-based SOTP target price for the common share is W490,000. Our 12-month target price for the preference share is W360,000, which is based on our target preferred-to-common shares discount of 27%, derived from averaging: 1) the preferred discount of the 2-factor model and 2) the average preference share discount to common shares during the past 1 month. We are Buy rated on both the common and preference shares.

Key downside risks: 1) major deterioration in memory supply/demand, 2) sharp contraction in smartphone margins, and 3) mobile OLED market share loss.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - SK Hynix Inc.

Valuation methodology: Our 2026E/27E avg. P/E-based 12m TP is W3,500,000, applying a target P/E multiple of 9.0X.

Key risks: Key risks include 1) major deterioration in memory supply/demand and delay in technology migration, 2) weaker demand for smartphones/PCs/servers which would impact overall conventional memory demand, 3) Samsung's positive HBM business progress which would impact HBM revenue and profit, 4) lower AI-related capex which would impact overall HBM demand, and thus HBM revenue/profit for the company.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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50%	34%	16%

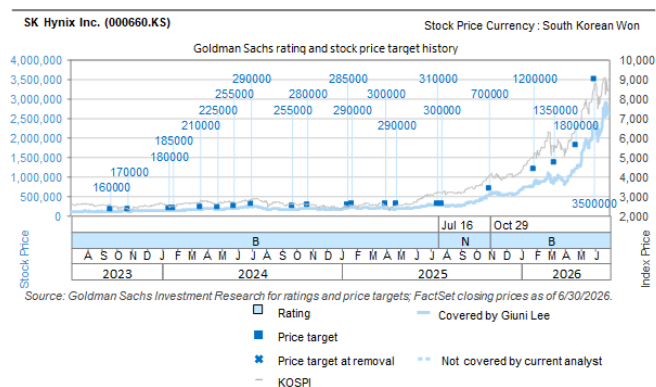
Investment Banking Relationships

Buy	Hold	Sell
65%	59%	43%

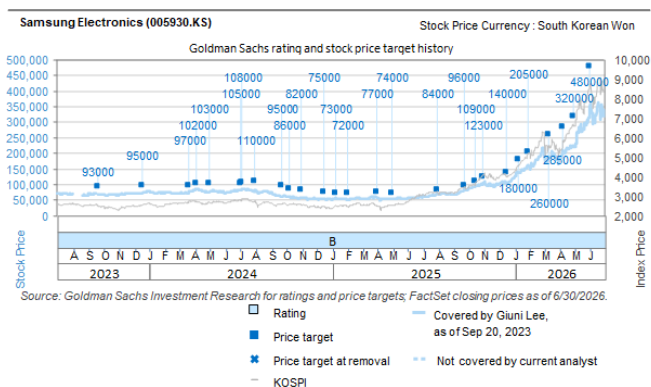
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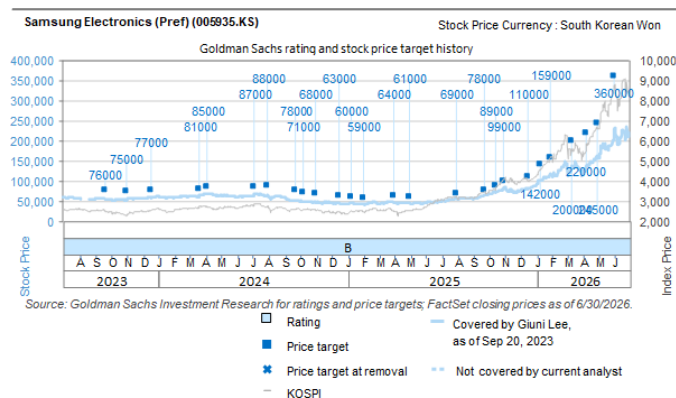
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Target price history table(s)

Samsung Electronics (Pref) (005935.KS)

Date of report	Target price (W)	Closing price (W)
31-May-26	360,000	202,500
30-Apr-26	245,000	158,300
07-Apr-26	220,000	130,900
11-Mar-26	200,000	138,900
29-Jan-26	159,000	115,600
08-Jan-26	142,000	101,900
16-Dec-25	110,000	79,800
30-Oct-25	99,000	82,500
14-Oct-25	89,000	72,300
22-Sep-25	78,000	66,700
31-Jul-25	69,000	57,600
01-May-25	61,000	46,850
01-Apr-25	64,000	47,700

Samsung Electronics (005930.KS)

Date of report	Target price (W)	Closing price (W)
30-Jul-26	490,000	207,000
31-May-26	480,000	317,000
30-Apr-26	320,000	220,500
07-Apr-26	285,000	196,500
11-Mar-26	260,000	190,000
29-Jan-26	205,000	160,700
08-Jan-26	180,000	138,800
16-Dec-25	140,000	102,800
30-Oct-25	123,000	104,100
14-Oct-25	109,000	91,600
22-Sep-25	96,000	83,500
31-Jul-25	84,000	71,400
01-May-25	74,000	55,500

Samsung Electronics (Pref) (005935.KS)

Date of report	Target price (W)	Closing price (W)
02-Feb-25	59,000	43,000
08-Jan-25	60,000	46,800
16-Dec-24	63,000	46,550
31-Oct-24	68,000	47,950
08-Oct-24	71,000	49,900
23-Sep-24	78,000	52,400
31-Jul-24	88,000	64,900
05-Jul-24	87,000	68,000
05-Apr-24	85,000	69,000
21-Mar-24	81,000	65,800
17-Dec-23	77,000	59,300
31-Oct-23	75,000	53,600
20-Sep-23	76,000	56,100

Samsung Electronics (005930.KS)

Date of report	Target price (W)	Closing price (W)
01-Apr-25	77,000	58,800
02-Feb-25	72,000	52,400
08-Jan-25	73,000	57,300
16-Dec-24	75,000	55,600
31-Oct-24	82,000	59,200
08-Oct-24	86,000	60,300
23-Sep-24	95,000	62,600
31-Jul-24	110,000	83,900
05-Jul-24	108,000	87,100
01-Jul-24	105,000	81,800
30-Apr-24	103,000	77,500
05-Apr-24	102,000	84,500
21-Mar-24	97,000	79,300
17-Dec-23	95,000	73,300
20-Sep-23	93,000	69,600

SK Hynix Inc. (000660.KS)

Date of report	Target price (W)	Closing price (W)
31-May-26	3,500,000	2,333,000
23-Apr-26	1,800,000	1,225,000
11-Mar-26	1,350,000	955,000
28-Jan-26	1,200,000	841,000
29-Oct-25	700,000	558,000
24-Jul-25	300,000	269,500
16-Jul-25	310,000	296,000
24-Apr-25	290,000	178,300
01-Apr-25	300,000	197,000
23-Jan-25	290,000	219,500
15-Jan-25	285,000	198,200
24-Oct-24	280,000	198,200
23-Sep-24	255,000	162,000
01-Jul-24	290,000	235,500
27-May-24	255,000	201,500
25-Apr-24	225,000	170,600
21-Mar-24	210,000	170,000
25-Jan-24	185,000	137,400
17-Jan-24	180,000	131,000
26-Oct-23	170,000	120,000
20-Sep-23	160,000	118,000

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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